



Maritime &
Coastguard
Agency

Guidance

MIN609 (M+F) Amendment 2

Implementation of electronic certificates

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1. Introduction/Background

1.1 The MCA has been engaged on a project to update the systems used to manage and record their Survey and Inspection activities. The new system, named PELORUS, provides a means to issue electronic certificates which will remove the need for UK vessels to hold signed paper copies of the statutory certificates issued by the MCA.

1.2 The implementation of PELORUS is the first in a number of digital enhancements to the methods by which survey and inspection information is shared with the industry.

1.3 The International Maritime Organisation (IMO) has issued guidance in Circular FAL.5/Circ.39/Rev.2 for the use of electronic certificates and this MIN sets out the MCA processes for compliance with the IMO guidelines.

1.4 Electronic certificates and copies of them will be accepted by Port State Control Officers based on the guidance provided in the Circular.

2. Implementation of Electronic Certificates

2.1 The PELORUS System is coming into use in the MCA on 24th February 2020 and certificates issued from this date may be electronic in format however a number of paper certificates will continue to be issued by the MCA during the implementation period.

2.2 Shipowners, operators and crews on ships that carry and use electronic certificates should ensure that these certificates are controlled through their safety management system and UK ships holding electronic certificates should retain a copy of this Marine Information Note for guidance on the detail of the IMO Circular and the process to verify the validity of the MCA certificates held.

2.3 Electronic certificates issued by the MCA contain the following features aligned with the requirements of IMO Circular FAL.5/Circ.39/Rev.2, the detail of which is provided in Annex 1 to this Note:

2.3.1 The format and content of the electronic certificates issued are consistent with the validity and format requirements of the relevant international convention or instrument, or national requirement as applicable;

2.3.2 The electronic certificates are protected from edits, modifications or revisions other than those authorised by the MCA;

2.3.3 Each electronic certificate has a unique tracking number (the certificate number) used for verification as described in this MIN;

2.3.4 A printable and visible UK government seal that confirms the MCA as the issuing authority.

3. Verification procedure

3.1 The following procedure should be used to verify the validity of electronic certificates issued by the MCA.

3.2 To verify an electronic certificate issued by the MCA the unique tracking number (Certificate number) and date of issue are required.

3.3 The verification module within PELORUS is accessed through the URL:

<https://maritimewindowuk.azurewebsites.net/verify>
(<https://maritimewindowuk.azurewebsites.net/verify>)

3.4 On entry, the entry form requests the Certificate number and Issued Date. It is vital that the details are entered accurately from the certificate with the date in the format DD-MM-YYYY. The format of the electronic certificates permits the copying of the certificate number from the header of the certificate for ease of transfer to the verification system.

3.5 The verification module allows a copy of the electronic certificate to be viewed.

3.6 In the event that verification is not possible through the above procedure, the MCA may be contacted directly on:

+44 (0)203 81 72190 - Office Hours (UK Time)

+44 (7)781 05 28504 - Duty Surveyor, Out of Hours (UK Time)

More Information

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Annex 1

Maritime and Coastguard
Agency Seal

Certificate Number


 Maritime &
Coastguard
Agency

ID: 7aeddb0e-0113-4bae-a964-b3e5159ae5cb

INTERNATIONAL TONNAGE CERTIFICATE (1969)
Issued under the provisions of the
International Convention on Tonnage Measurement of Ships (1969)
under the authority of the Government of
the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland
by the Maritime and Coastguard Agency, an Executive Agency of the Department for Transport

PARTICULARS OF SHIP			
Name of Ship	EXAMPLE	IMO Number	1234567
Port of Registry	London	Official Number	123456
		Distinctive Number or Letters	AAAA
Date on which the keel was laid or the ship was at a similar stage of construction, (Article 2(5)), or date on which the ship underwent alterations or modifications of a major character, (Article 3(2)(b)), as appropriate.			01 January 2000

MAIN DIMENSIONS		
Length (m) (Article 2(8))	Breadth (m) (Regulation 2(2))	Moulded Depth amidships to Upper Deck (m) (Regulation 2(2))
100.000	10.000	10.000

THE TONNAGES OF THE SHIP ARE:	
GROSS TONNAGE	750.00
NET TONNAGE	50

THIS IS TO CERTIFY
that the tonnages of this ship have been determined in accordance with the provisions of the International Convention on Tonnage Measurement of Ships, 1969.

Issued at London

Date of issue 31 January 2020

Signed

Signature of authorized official issuing the certificate

Name

This certificate ceases to be valid if any alterations are made to the form or capacity of the ship or if it is discovered that the tonnage of the ship has been wrongly measured or calculated.

1/2 MSF 2300 v1.0

Annex 1 Format of electronic certificate

Annex 2

A2.1 Certificate valid

When the correct details are entered into the verification web page, the page will confirm that details entered represent a valid certificate. An ability to display the certificate is also provided.

The screenshot shows a web interface titled "Verify Certificate". It has two input fields: "Certificate Number" with the value "7a6000be-0113-40ae-a06e-53ed1f5ba5c6" and "Issued Date" with the value "31-01-2020". A blue "Verify" button is to the right of the date field. Below the inputs, a green box with the word "Valid" is displayed. Underneath this, a message states "The Certificate is valid." and there is a green "Show Certificate" button.

Certificate valid

A2.2 Certificate not valid

When the incorrect details are entered into the verification web page, the page will appear as follows:

Verify Certificate

Certificate Number	Issued Date
72e4d83ee-0113-484ee-9f028-83a5f133a0999	31-07-2020

Invalid!

The Certificate does not exist or is invalid.

Certificate not valid



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